Kenshi Online — Multiplayer guide

Co-op multiplayer mod for Kenshi 1.0.68 (Steam) · up to 16 players · install, host and join

1. Requirements

- Windows 10/11 64-bit and **Kenshi 1.0.68 (Steam)**. The version is shown in the bottom-right corner of the main menu.
- **Every player** installs the same version of the mod.
- Close Kenshi before installing.

2. Install (one click)

1	Download **KenshiOnline_Setup.exe** and double-click it. Accept the Windows admin prompt (**Yes**).
2	If the blue “Windows protected your PC” screen appears, click **More info** → **Run anyway** (the installer is not code-signed).
3	Choose your language. The installer finds the Kenshi folder by itself; if not, click **Browse** and pick the folder that contains **kenshi_x64.exe**.
4	Click **Install** and then **Finish**. That's it.

To uninstall: Windows Settings → Apps → **Kenshi Online** → Uninstall. Your original files are backed up in **Kenshi\KenshiMP_backup**.

3. Host a game (only the host)

1	In the Kenshi folder, double-click `KenshiMP.Server.exe`. A black console opens: that is the server. **Keep it open** while you play.
2	If Windows Firewall asks, allow access on private and public networks.
3	Open port **27800 UDP** in your router (Port forwarding / NAT): external and internal port 27800, protocol UDP, destination = your PC's local IPv4 (run `ipconfig`).
4	Give your friends your **public IP** (search “what is my ip”). On the same network use your local IP instead.

Can't open ports (CG-NAT, 4G/5G, student housing)? Use a free virtual LAN such as **Radmin VPN**, **ZeroTier** or **Tailscale**: everybody joins the same network and you share the IP that the VPN gives you.

4. Play (everyone, host included)

1	Start Kenshi from Steam (“Play Kenshi”, not the modding tool) and press **OK** in the launcher.
2	Click **NEW GAME**. Use the arrow until the start says **Multiplayer** and click **START**.
3	Create your character (any race: Human, Shek, Hive, Skeleton…) and click **CONFIRM**.
4	Wait about **90 seconds** until the **KENSHI ONLINE** bar appears at the top of the screen.
5	Press **F1** (close Kenshi's tutorial window if it also opens) → **JOIN GAME**.
6	Server IP: the host's IP (the host himself types `127.0.0.1`), port **27800**, your name → **CONNECT**.
7	The top bar shows “CONNECTED as <name> | N players online”. You are moved next to the host and everybody sees the others with their own look.

The game remembers the IP: next time it connects by itself about 90 s after the world loads. Join with F1 only after you are in the world (not from the main menu).

5. Controls

Key	Action
F1	Multiplayer menu (join / disconnect)
Enter	Chat
Tab	Player list
Esc	Close the current panel

6. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
“Connection failed” / retrying	Check the IP: the default field may contain another address — delete it and type the host's IP. The server console must be open and port 27800 UDP forwarded (or use a VPN).
F1 does nothing	The mod is still waiting for the world: wait until the KENSHI ONLINE bar appears (~90 s).
Only an animal / can't choose race	You picked the wrong start or have an old version. Reinstall and choose the **Multiplayer** start.
Many “Player 1” characters	That is the “Singleplayer” start of an old version. Reinstall and use the Multiplayer start.
Game closes when the 2nd player joins / on load	Old DLL. Reinstall with the latest installer. Do not use the original install.bat or Injector.
Crash on autosave with two Kenshi on ONE PC	Both copies share the save folder. Play on separate PCs (testing two copies on one PC is not supported).

7. Known limitations (alpha)

- Synced: player positions, characters and their appearance (race, face, hair, body), chat.

- Combat damage is not fully synced yet and NPC AI runs locally on each PC, so fights may differ between players.
- Pause and game speed are controlled by the server.
- Back up your saves (%LOCALAPPDATA%\kenshi\save) before playing.

Based on **Kenshi-Online** by The404Studios (MIT license). This build fixes the crashes on load/join, player detection, race selection, remote player spawning and appearance sync.